

LUTHANDO CANDLOVU Email: luthando.candlovu30@gmail.com | Phone: **078 276 5932**

Location: Bizana, Eastern Cape, South Africa | **Portfolio:** <https://luthandocandlovu.github.io/MY-PORTFOLIO/>

Professional Summary

Motivated Computer Science graduate from University of Fort Hare with strong programming, problem-solving, and analytical skills. Experienced in academic mentoring, effective communication of technical concepts, and collaborative problem-solving. Motivated to apply technology to real-world challenges, with a focus on cybersecurity and machine learning

Technical Skills

- **Languages:** Python, Java, C++, SQL, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Bash/Shell
- **Tools & Frameworks:** Git, VS Code, Jupyter Notebook
- **Core Knowledge:** Data Structures & Algorithms, Machine Learning (Basics), Cybersecurity Concepts, Software Engineering
- **Soft Skills:** Communication, Team Collaboration, Academic Mentoring, Problem Solving

Education

University of Fort Hare

Degree in Computer Science

Relevant Coursework: Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Data Structures & Algorithms, Cybersecurity, Software Engineering

Certificates

- AI-Governance-Certification-Security-Education
 - Linux Certificate
 - Python Certificate
 - Cisco Certificate
 - Introduction in Cyber Security
 - Hackathon Certificate
 - Inkanyezi IT Audit & Cyber Security Academy
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Projects

AI-Based Zero-Day Attack Detection (Honours Project)

- Built an anomaly-based intrusion detection system using machine learning.
- Applied Isolation Forest and Autoencoders on network traffic datasets (UNSW-NB15, CICIDS2017).
- Focused on detecting unknown cyber threats with minimal labeled data.

Phishing Detection System

- Developed a machine learning tool to identify phishing URLs and emails.
- Implemented classification models and data preprocessing in Python.

AI Cyber Threat Detection & Dashboard

- Created a security monitoring tool with ML-based threat detection.
- Visualized threat levels using interactive dashboards.

Stock Price Prediction

- Built a machine learning model to predict stock trends using historical data.
- Used Python, pandas, and regression/forecasting techniques.

Ikhaya Mobile App (React Native)

- Developed a cross-platform mobile application using React Native and TypeScript.
- Focused on user experience and community-driven features. Khaya is the intelligent assistant that makes student accommodation life seamless, efficient, and stress-free. No more lost maintenance forms, confusing residence rules, or missed announcements just natural conversations with your AI residence companion.

BloomMobile (GitHub)

- Developed a mobile app featuring a chatbot and interactive UI with TypeScript.
 - Highlighted proficiency in mobile development and UI design.
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Experience

Peer Mentor – University of Fort Hare (2023–2024)

- Supported Computer Science students in analytical problem-solving and computational thinking.
- Guided learners in understanding data-driven concepts, algorithms, and system behaviour.
- Applied structured feedback to improve accuracy, reasoning, and technical confidence.
- Built strong skills in analysis, pattern recognition, and technical communication.

Volunteer (2025) – Fost Discovery (Science & Agriculture Department)

- Supported the planning and execution of science outreach and student engagement initiatives.
- Promoted STEM education by assisting with awareness programs in local communities, encouraging learner participation and interest in science and technology.

Research Work (In Progress)

Enhancing Problem-Solving Skills in Computer Science Through Collaborative Learning

- Co-authored an academic manuscript analysing the impact of peer mentoring on learning outcomes

Languages

- **English:** Fluent
- **isiXhosa:** Fluent
- **isiZulu:** Intermediate

References

- **Mr. Lazola Mcedani**, University of Fort Hare – 081 323 279 | LAMcedani@ufh.ac.za
 - **Prof. Nobert Jere**, University of Fort Hare – 061 867 8851
 - **Mr. Phumezo Kwinana**, Fosst Discovery Center – 061 564 0489
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